

family-emergency-plan

The Family Emergency Plan™

Lock In Your Meeting Points, Contacts, and Reconnect Protocol — Before You Need It

Why this worksheet exists: After a significant earthquake, phone networks jam, family members may be scattered (school, work, errands), and panic makes decision-making worse, not better. A written, rehearsed plan removes the guesswork exactly when guessing is most dangerous. This is a fill-in-the-blanks worksheet — complete it once, review it every 90 days, and post copies where every family member can see them.

How to run it: Fill in every blank as a family. Print at least 3 copies: one on the fridge, one in the go-bag (Tool #3), and one in each family member's wallet/bag as a wallet card (template at the bottom).

Section 1 — Household Members & Key Info

Name	Age	Phone	School/Work	Medical notes

Section 2 — The Meeting Points

Rule: pick TWO — one close, one far — because the close one may be inaccessible.

- **Meeting Point #1 (right outside your home):**
_____ (e.g., “the mailbox at the end of the driveway” — specific, not vague)
- **Meeting Point #2 (neighborhood, walkable):**
_____ (e.g., “the flagpole at [school/park name]” — pick somewhere everyone knows)
- **Meeting Point #3 (out-of-area, in case you can't get home):**
_____ (a relative's house or landmark outside your immediate area)

Rule for kids at school: Know your school's official reunification procedure — schools have their own protocol, and children should follow the school's plan first, not try to walk home on their own unless instructed.

Section 3 — The Out-of-Area Contact

Pick ONE person who lives outside your region (different city/state) as the single point of contact everyone calls/texts. Local networks jam; long-distance often works.

- **Out-of-area contact name:** _____
- **Their phone:** _____
- **Backup out-of-area contact:** _____

The rule: everyone in the family texts (not calls) this person to check in as soon as possible. This person relays messages between family members who can't reach each other directly.

Section 4 — The Communication Protocol

1. **Text first, call second.** Text messages queue and deliver even when voice networks are jammed; calls often fail to connect during high-traffic events.
 2. **Check in with the out-of-area contact within the first hour if possible** — even a one-word “safe” text.
 3. **Don't drive to check on people unless necessary.** Roads may be damaged or congested; a phone check-in is safer and faster than driving across town.
 4. **Social media as backup.** If phone networks are fully down, a public “marking safe” post can reach people faster than a jammed network — but is not a replacement for the direct out-of-area contact check-in.
 5. **Designate a family group chat** now, so everyone already has the thread ready: _____ (app/platform used)
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Section 5 — Utility Shutoff Assignments

Assign WHO in the household is responsible for each shutoff (everyone capable should know the location, but one person is the designated “goes first”):

- **Gas shutoff — assigned to:** _____ (see Tool #6 for exact procedure)
- **Water shutoff — assigned to:** _____
- **Electrical panel — assigned to:** _____

Rule: never turn the gas back on yourself after a shutoff — that's the utility company's job, once they've confirmed it's safe.

Section 6 — Pet Plan

- **Pet(s):** _____
 - **Who is responsible for each pet during evacuation:**

 - **Pet-friendly shelter or boarding option (research now, not during):** _____
 - **Pet supplies location (tie to go-bag, Tool #3):**

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Section 7 — Special Needs & Dependents

- Household member with medical/mobility needs:

 - Specific plan for their evacuation/assistance:

 - Backup caregiver if primary caregiver is unavailable:

 - Elderly relative/neighbor you're responsible for checking on:

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Section 8 — Utility & Emergency Numbers (fill in your local numbers)

- Gas company emergency line: _____
 - Water utility emergency line: _____
 - Electric utility emergency line: _____
 - Local emergency management / OES office:

 - Non-emergency police line: _____
 - Family doctor / pediatrician: _____
 - Nearest hospital: _____
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Wallet Card Template (cut out, one per family member)

IN CASE OF EARTHQUAKE — MY EMERGENCY PLAN

Meeting Point #1: _____

Meeting Point #2: _____

Out-of-area contact: _____

Their phone: _____

My allergies/meds: _____

The Verdict Sheet

- Plan completed and reviewed by whole family? Y / N
 - Copies posted (fridge / go-bag / wallets)? _____ of 3+
 - School reunification procedure confirmed with school? Y / N
 - Out-of-area contact briefed and agreed to the role? Y / N
 - Next review date (90 days out): _____
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Pro Tips From the Field

1. **Actually call your out-of-area contact and ask them.** Don't just write their name down — confirm they're willing and understand the role.
2. **Practice the text-check-in once, unannounced,** as part of your Drop-Cover-Hold drill (Tool #4) — send the real text to the real contact so everyone knows the flow.
3. **Update the plan every time something changes:** new school, new job, new pet, new phone number. Tie updates to your 12-Week

Tracker (Tool #8) reviews.

4. **Laminate the fridge copy.** It needs to survive years of kitchen life to be there when you need it.
 5. **Teach kids the plan in simple terms they can repeat back to you** — “if we’re not together, go to the flagpole, and Aunt Jamie will know where everyone is.”
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Your Next Step

You have the plan. Now execute: fill in every blank today, confirm the out-of-area contact, and post the copies. Then move to the **Aftershock & Post-Quake Safety Card (Tool #6)** so you know exactly what to do in the critical first hour after the shaking stops.

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Educational content only; always confirm your school’s official
reunification procedure and your local utility emergency shutoff
guidance.*